

Clearer Skin, Smoother Care: Dermatology Pharmacist-Provider Co-Management in Isotretinoin Therapy for Better Outcomes and Increased Provider Access

Amanda M. Popko PharmD, BCACP, Susanne Burns PharmD, MBA, Cara Ciamacco, PharmD

Geisinger, Danville, PA

Geisinger

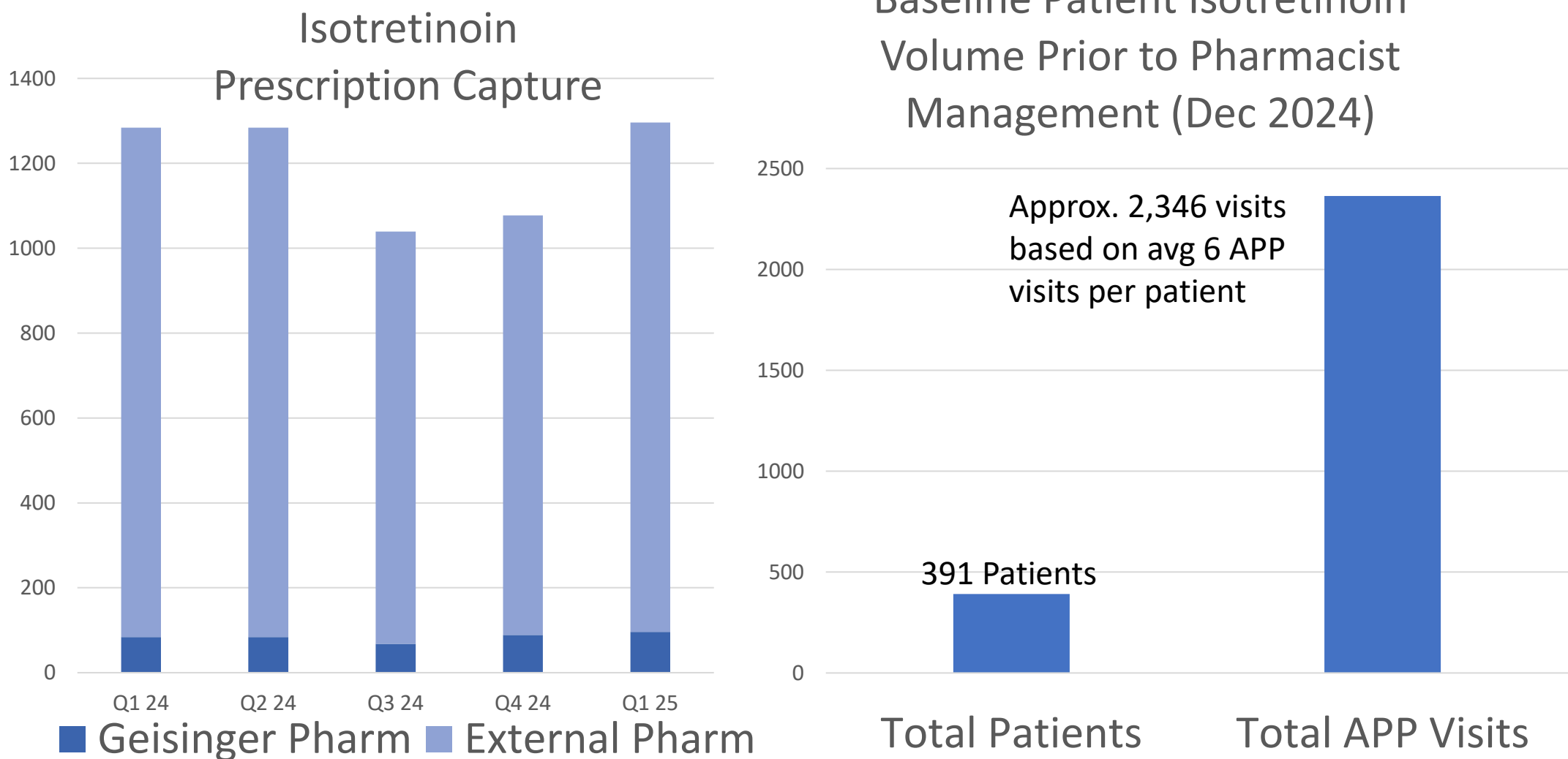
Background

- Isotretinoin is a highly effective treatment for severe acne but requires strict adherence to iPLEDGE requirements and frequent monitoring.¹ These demands can burden dermatology providers and limit patient access.
- Integrating pharmacists into the care model offers a promising solution to streamline care, improve adherence, and enhance provider efficiency.

Objectives

- Evaluate the impact of pharmacist-provider co-management on:
 - Provider access
 - Patient adherence to iPLEDGE requirements
 - Prescription capture within the health system pharmacy
 - Success of dose adjustments and pharmacist-led interventions

Baseline Metrics



Process:

Visit	Timeline	Action
Provider	Decision to Start	- Order labs & activate iPLEDGE - Refer to Pharmacist
Pharmacist	Initial Touchpoint	- Reviw baseline and order future labs - Review beta-hcg and complete iPLEDGE (if applicable) - Order Rx to Geisinger Pharmacy - Authorization coordination
Treatment Initiation		
Pharmacist	Month 1 & 2	- Tolerability assessment - Review labs - Dose titration - Complete iPLEDGE - Order Rx to Geisinger Pharmacy
Pharmacist	Month 3 & 4	- Tolerability assessment - Dose adjustment if needed - Complete iPLEDGE - Order Rx to Geisinger Pharmacy
Provider	Month 5	- Treatment completed: Pharmacist follow up month 6 - Treatment not completed: Provider follow up month 6 - Complete iPLEDGE (if applicable)
Treatment Discontinuation		
Pharmacist	Final Visit	- Sign off from patient care - Complete final documentation in iPLEDGE (if applicable)

Evaluation Methods:

- Appointment access for providers referring into co-management program
- PDC for patients on isotretinoin managed through this process
- Provider and patient survey
- Prescription capture rate to health system pharmacy

Anticipated Outcomes:

- Pharmacist-provider co-management in isotretinoin therapy significantly improves provider access by reducing required touchpoints by provider.
- Pharmacist-led coordination, counseling, and medication management enhance patient adherence and satisfaction.
- Increased prescription capture through health system pharmacy creates operational and financial value.

Next Steps:

- Expand to include all dermatology practices in the health system
- Evaluate the interventions completed by the pharmacist
- Explore opportunity to implement similar co-management workflows in other disease states

Acknowledgements

Nicole Kropa, PharmD, Madelyn Stabinski, PharmD

References

1. U.S. Food and Drug Administration. (n.d.). *Questions and answers on the iPLEDGE REMS*. FDA. Retrieved July 17, 2025, from <https://www.fda.gov/drugs/postmarket-drug-safety-information-patients-and-providers/questions-and-answers-iplodge-rems>